

StepCat

Payout Calculator

Quick Start Guide

App v252.1 and Profitability Workbook v252.1

Estimate payouts, record completed results, and copy exact rows into the matching workbook.

Release note

v252.1 R9 keeps the tested calculation and Saved History behavior while clarifying the Optional Fields drawer, centering the main Write Feedback text, and adding helper descriptions beneath every Quick Explanation title. Existing v252 Google Sheets copies remain usable; the v252.1 spreadsheet remains an optional visual-clarity update.

This guide is for StepCat users. It explains the current app and workbook workflow without developer-facing implementation notes.

Contents

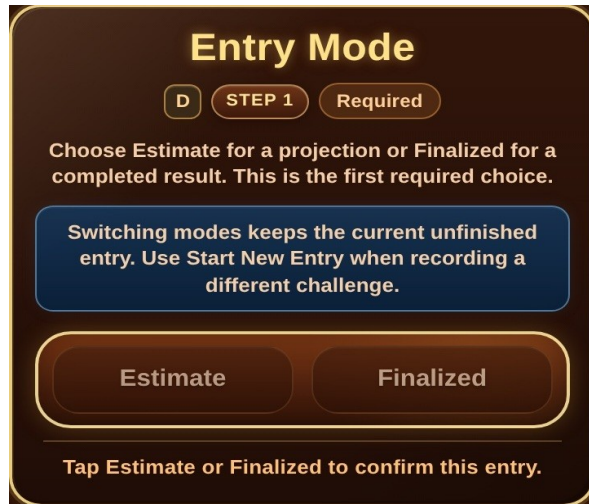
1. Follow the four-step entry sequence
2. Complete Game Entry (Step 3)
3. Show Optional Fields only when needed
4. Calculate Result (Step 4), save, and understand the result
5. Use Saved History and SC Record IDs
6. Finalize an Estimate in place
7. Copy records into the workbook
8. Review workbook reports
9. Personalize Settings safely
10. Find Help & Resources
11. Install StepCat or create a shortcut
12. Send feedback
13. Migrate old workbook data
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Fastest workflow

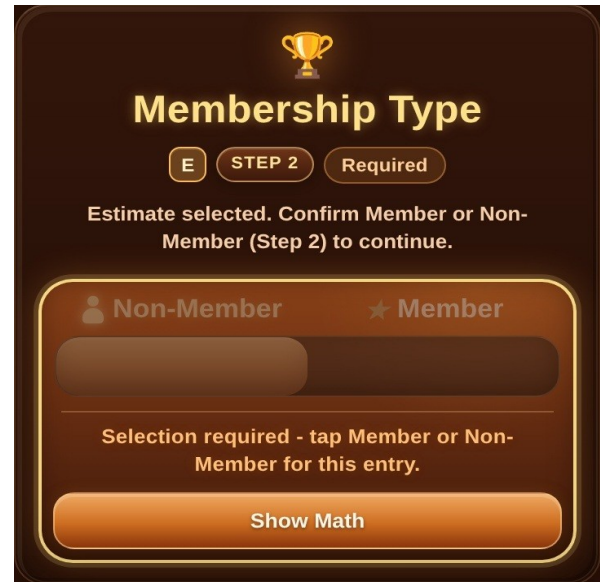
Choose Entry Mode (Step 1), confirm Membership Type (Step 2), complete Game Entry (Step 3), then use Calculate Result (Step 4). Tap Show Optional Fields only for names, dates, payment labels, or other optional record details.

1. Follow the four-step entry sequence

Entry Mode is Step 1. Gold marks the single current action, green marks a completed step, and locked steps remain neutral. Choose Estimate for a projection or Finalized for a completed challenge. Membership Type is Step 2: it stays dimmed until Step 1 is confirmed, then receives a gold edge until Member or Non-Member is selected. During Step 3, the gold cue advances to the first incomplete required field. When the entry is ready, Step 4 receives the gold edge.



Entry Mode is Step 1 and begins the workflow.



Membership Type is Step 2 and is required before calculation.

Membership math

Member uses the full Gross Pot. Non-Member uses the adjusted pot after the 15% deduction. Show Math explains the active calculation.

Remember Entry Mode and Remember Membership are optional Settings. When either is off, StepCat intentionally asks for a fresh selection after refresh or reopening.

2. Complete Game Entry (Step 3)

Estimate

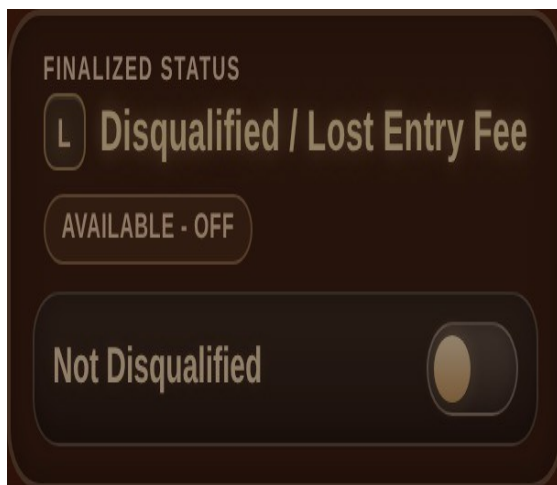
- Gross Pot — Required in Estimate; Optional in Finalized.
- Entry Fee
- Eligible Players — Required in Estimate; Optional in Finalized.

Total Players — Optional. When entered, it supports eliminated-player and elimination-rate calculations.

Finalized

- Entry Fee
- Final Earned / Chips — Required in Finalized unless Disqualified is selected.

Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee appears immediately before Final Earned. It is gray when unavailable, muted amber when available and off, and red when selected. Turning it on sets Final Earned to zero and locks the field for the current result.



Disqualified is off and Final Earned remains available.



Final Earned records the total returned, not profit alone.

Free Game rule

A Free Game must have a \$0 Entry Fee. StepCat blocks a Free Game with a paid fee in both Estimate and Finalized modes. A \$0 entry is recorded as Free Game.

3. Show Optional Fields only when needed

Game Entry contains the calculation fields. Optional Fields contains optional game and workbook information. When closed, its helper describes the extra details available. When opened, the control changes to Hide Optional Fields and the helper changes to Collapse the optional information shown below.

- Game Name
- Game Start Date and Game End Date
- Date Format — a web setting that controls copied date display; it is not a Required or Optional record field.
- Payment / Record Type
- Optional statistics when available
- Notes

Optional Fields opened with state-specific Hide helper text.

Calculate & Save validates and stores one result.

Notes can store unusual entry details or a cash-and-points breakdown.

Drawer behavior

Default-open Settings apply when StepCat loads or refreshes. They do not override a drawer that you manually opened or closed during the current session.

4. Calculate Result (Step 4), save, and understand the result

After completing Game Entry (Step 3), use Calculate Result (Step 4) and tap Calculate & Save. The readiness notice appears above Calculate & Save. StepCat scrolls to the first invalid field when correction is needed. A successful save clears the completed draft so it does not return as unfinished work.

Result	Meaning
Profit	Final Earned is greater than Entry Fee. Profit is the difference.
Draw	A normal completed return at or below Entry Fee. Net Profit is \$0.00.
Disqualified	A paid entry loses the full Entry Fee. Free Games record the status without a monetary loss.
Free Game	Return is recorded as chips or game credit. Cash Net Profit is \$0.00 and ROI is N/A.
Estimate	Projection only. Accounting Result and ROI remain N/A until finalized.

Newest saved Estimate with a Finalize This Estimate action.

Finalized Saved History card with result and accounting values.

5. Use Saved History and SC Record IDs

Saved History persists on the device. Copy All Sheet Rows remains the primary action; copy guidance appears next, followed by Restore History and Clear History as maintenance controls. Each record receives a permanent, non-editable SC Record ID such as SC-0023. The ID identifies the app record; it is not a workbook row number.

- Named records display the SC ID as small secondary text.
- An unnamed record uses a fallback such as Unnamed Game - SC-0023.
- The same ID remains through Estimate finalization, editing, deletion Undo, and restoration.
- Deleted IDs are not reused or renumbered.
- Copy This Sheet Row copies one record; Copy All Sheet Rows copies all saved records without headers.

Example Estimate

RECORD SC-0001

Estimate Member

Copy This Sheet Row

Finalize This Estimate

ESTIMATED EARNED \$10.00	ACCOUNTING RESULT N/A until finalized	ROI N/A
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Payment / Record Type	Cash
Entry Fee	\$10.00
Gross Pot	\$200.00
Players	20 eligible
Estimated Break-Even Point	20 eligible players
Current Position	At the estimated break-even point

Copy This Sheet Row prepares the exact A-M record values.

Deletion and restoration

Individual Delete offers a short Undo action. Restore History is a separate backup operation and warns before replacing non-empty current history.

6. Finalize an Estimate in place

Use Finalize This Estimate when a projected challenge ends. StepCat updates the same Saved History item instead of creating a duplicate. Its SC Record ID, original order, Gross Pot, Entry Fee, player counts, Membership Type, and Payment / Record Type remain attached to the record.

Finalize This Estimate ✕

Example Estimate will be updated in place. Gross Pot, Entry Fee, player counts, and Membership Type are retained.

Final Earned / Chips Required

Total returned

☐ **Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee**

Game End Date Optional

mm/dd/yyyy

Notes Optional

Optional final notes

Cancel **Save as Finalized**

Enter the completed Final Earned / Chips and any optional final details.

- The Saved History count does not increase.
- The card changes from Estimate to Finalized in its original position.
- StepCat scrolls to the record that was actually updated.
- The original Estimated Earned and the difference from Estimate remain visible when available.

Workbook update

After finalizing an Estimate, copy the finalized A-M row over that game's existing A-M workbook row. Do not add a second workbook row for the same game.

7. Copy records into the workbook

The app copies input values only. In the workbook, columns A-M are inputs and columns N-Z contain formulas. Never paste over N-Z.

1. Open Game Records in the StepCat workbook.
2. Tap the first empty cell in column A, such as A5 in a blank workbook.
3. Tap Copy This Sheet Row in StepCat, or Copy All Sheet Rows for the full history.
4. Paste into the selected column-A cell.
5. Check that the row appears across A-M and that N-Z calculates automatically.

Game Records — Editable Input Columns A-M

Where cells are editable. Formula columns begin at N and should not be overwritten.

Press to edit column widths.

Game Name	Start Date	End Date	Entry Mode	Game Type	Payoff / Return %	Game Fee / Chip	Entry Fee	High Roller	Total Payouts	Total Earned / Chips	Disqualified / Lost	Notes
Recent Speculation	05/17/2025	05/20/2025	Manual	Non-Hardhat	Cash	\$2,765.00	\$0.00	Nil	1,138	15.51	No	
Recent Chicago	05/17/2025	05/20/2025	Manual	Non-Hardhat	Cash	\$8,000.00	\$0.00	Nil	400	45.00	No	
Week Your Way To The Top	05/17/2025	05/20/2025	Manual	Non-Hardhat	Cash	\$4,000.00	\$0.00	Nil	200	5.00	No	
Steps of Power	05/20/2025	05/20/2025	Manual	Non-Hardhat	Cash	\$8,000.00	\$0.00	Nil	615	45.00	No	

Game Records Search Records Statistics Game Comparisons Sort Records

Game Records — Formula Columns N-Z

Calculated columns update automatically. Estimates show risk in ascending columns and carry Column Z forward unchanged.

Nil — Formula columns — do not edit

Adjusted Pst. Chips	Estimated Earned / Chips	Result Earned / Chips	Profit	Draw	Lost	RIS	Result	Challenge Length (weeks)	Net Profit	Eliminated Players	Elimination Rate	Projecting Net Profit
\$9,340.00	25.52	27.91	\$0.91	\$0.00	\$0.00	0.0%	Profit	4	\$0.91	279	17.2%	\$0.91
\$5,360.00	38.83	40.00	\$0.00	\$40.00	\$0.00	0.0%	Draw	5	\$0.00	36	12.4%	\$0.91
\$2,870.00	42.85	0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$40.00	-100.0%	Disqualified	6	\$-40.00	72	25.0%	\$-39.09
\$0,910.00	35.99	40.00	\$0.00	\$40.00	\$0.00	0.0%	Draw	1	\$0.00	34	5.5%	\$-39.09
\$0,547.50	47.36	0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	0.0%	Draw	3	\$0.00	89	15.3%	\$-39.09
\$00,822.00	46.48	46.48	\$5.48	\$0.00	\$0.00	16.2%	Profit	5	\$6.48	2,438	26.9%	\$-32.61

Game Records Search Records Statistics Game Comparisons Sort Records

Game Records input columns begin at A-M.

Formula columns N-Z calculate automatically and should not be edited.

Do not enter cell-edit mode

Select the cell itself before pasting. Pasting while editing inside a cell can place the entire copied row into one cell.

8. Review workbook reports

The workbook uses the copied A-M values to calculate accounting fields, review data, and build report sheets. Estimate rows remain projections until finalized.

Record Review — Formula-Driven Review and Totals							
Do not type or paste into Record Review. Estimate rows are labeled Estimate; only finalized games contribute to review totals.							
Record Review — Game Index and Field Review — v252							
Formula-driven view only — do not type or paste into Record Review. Enter or edit records in Game Records A-M. Blank rows are expected until matching non-subscription games exist. Selecting a prepared cell may show a formula in the formula bar; the worksheet cell should display its calculated result or remain blank.							
Game #	Game Records ID	Game Name	Calculated Result	Review Status	Blank Fields to Review	Notes from Game Records	
1	G-0001	Beyond Spectacular	Profit	No Highlighted Fields			Review Totals
2	G-0002	Passport Chicago	Draw	No Highlighted Fields			Total Games
3	G-0003	Walk Your Way To The Top	Disqualified	No Highlighted Fields			Profit Games
4	G-0004	Steps of Honor	Draw	No Highlighted Fields			Draw Games
5	G-0005	StepBet Block Party	Draw	No Highlighted Fields			Disqualified Games
6	G-0006	Step Bet With Jenna	Profit	No Highlighted Fields			Free Games
7	G-0007	Strides For Juneteenth	Profit	No Highlighted Fields			Points Games
8	G-0008	Step Right Up	Draw	No Highlighted Fields			Cash / Hybrid Games
							184
							129
							39
							7
							2
							139
							43

Record Review summarizes review status and points to fields that need attention.

Summary — Exact Counts and Cash / Credit Totals					
Free Game chips and Estimate rows remain separate from every realized cash profit total.					
StepCat Live Summary Dashboard - v252					
Game Result	Game Count	Share of Paid Games	Cash / Credit Total	Amount	What It Represents
Profit Games	129	73.7%	Running Net Game Profit	\$154.85	Gross profit minus lost entry fees
Draw Games	39	22.3%	Gross Profit Earned	\$654.85	Positive paid-game cash profit entry, before lost fees or membership costs
Disqualified Games	7	4.0%	Total Lost Entry Fees	\$480.00	Full entry fees lost from disqualification
Current Workbook Paid Games	175	100.0%	Membership Fees	\$63.59	Annual membership cost, tracked as a separate non-game expense
Prior Completed Games (reference)	0		Actual Running Net Profit	\$91.26	Running cash net game profit minus current and carried-over membership costs
Completed Free Games (separate credit)	2	Separate	Free Game Chips Earned	2.82 chips	Non-cash chips/game credit earned from Free Games, excluded from every cash profit total

Summary presents totals and result counts.

Best Results — Live Reference Table			
Values update automatically as Game Records change.			
Best Results - Live Reference Table - v252			
Shows the strongest finalized results found in Game Records. Estimate rows are excluded; values update automatically when records are added or changed.			
Metric	Game	Value	Meaning
Highest Net Profit	Summer's Last Push	\$20.23	Largest positive game result
Highest ROI	Summer's Last Push	33.7%	Best return on Entry Fee
Largest Lost Entry Fee	\$100 Swap Battle	\$100.00	Largest full-entry loss
Lowest Elimination Rate	Beyond Spectacular	17.1%	Best recorded elimination rate
Longest Challenge	Marathon To 2026	60	Most weeks completed

Best Results highlights top completed records.

Workbook comparisons

Game Comparisons — Paid Games and Free Game Chips

Paid Game Performance — v252

Compares paid completed Member, Non-Member, and Unclassified games. Subscriptions are excluded; Free Games appear in the separate section below.

Metric	Member	Non-Member	Unclassified	All Paid Games
Completed Games	28	59	88	175
Profit Games	27	39	63	129
Profit Rate	96.4%	66.1%	71.6%	73.7%
Draw Rate	0.0%	32.2%	22.7%	22.3%
Disqualification Rate	3.6%	1.7%	5.7%	4.0%
Average Net Profit	\$5.57	\$1.54	\$-1.05	\$0.88
Average ROI	11.5%	3.8%	1.1%	3.7%
Total Net Profit	\$156.09	\$91.02	\$-92.26	\$154.85
Unclassified Games	0	0	88	88

Free Game Chip Performance

Free Games are completed step challenges that award non-cash chips/game credit. They remain separate from paid-game ROI, paid-result averages, and all cash profit totals.

Metric	Free Game Chips	What It Represents
Completed Free Games	2	All finalized Free Game and Disqualified — Free Game records.
Non-disqualified Free Games	2	Free Games completed without disqualification.
Disqualified Free Games	0	Free Games whose disqualification status was recorded.
Disqualification Rate	0.0%	Disqualified Free Games divided by all completed Free Games.
Average Chips Earned	2.82 chips	Average of recorded chip amounts only; unknown blanks are excluded, while recorded 0.00-chip results remain included.
Total Chips Earned	2.82 chips	Combined non-cash chips/game credit; excluded from overall cash running net profit.
Average Eliminated Players	11,900	Average eliminated-player count when player totals are available.
Average Elimination Rate	63.9%	Average elimination rate when player totals are available.
Average ROI	N/A	N/A because Free Games have a \$0.00 Entry Fee.
All Completed Games	177	All Paid Games plus completed Free Games; Subscription rows are excluded.

Instructions

Game Records

Record Review

Summary

Game Comparisons

Best Results

Game Comparisons groups completed records for comparison.

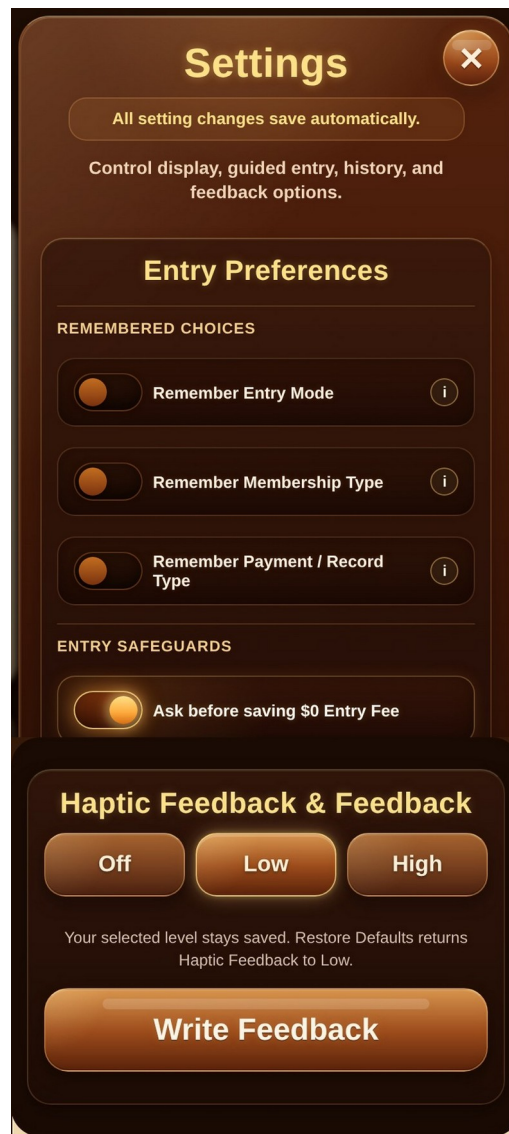
Older invalid rows

Record Review flags Free Game rows with a non-zero Entry Fee. Valid Free Games with a \$0 Entry Fee are treated normally.

9. Personalize Settings safely

All ordinary setting changes save automatically. The X closes Settings; it is not a Save button. Restore Defaults is the one bulk action that requires confirmation.

- Entry Preferences: remember Entry Mode, Membership Type, Payment / Record Type, unfinished Game Entry inputs, and the \$0 Entry Fee warning.
- Section Display & Starting State: choose which sections are visible and which start open after load or refresh.
- Help & Guides: remember guide progress.
- Haptic Feedback & Feedback: choose Off, Low, or High vibration feedback. The main Write Feedback action uses the same orange gradient and light text as Show Math, with its title and helper text centered at every phone width.



Haptic Feedback appears before Help & Guides, and all ordinary setting changes save automatically.

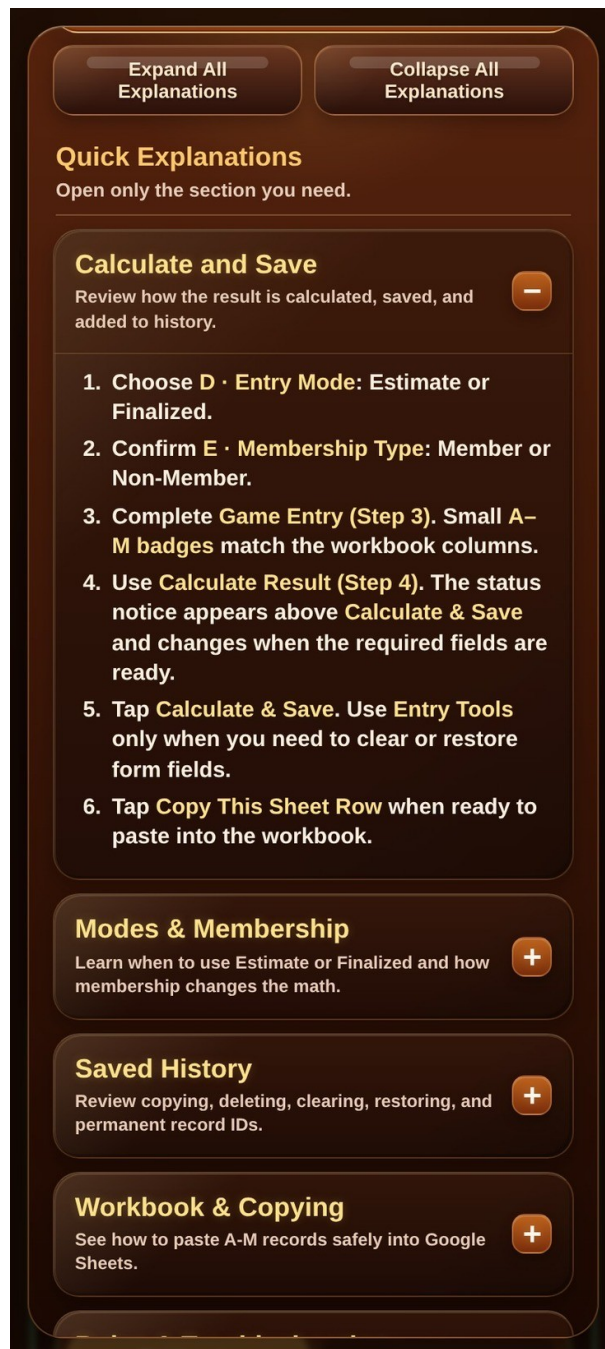
Restore Defaults

Confirming Restore Defaults returns all app settings, including Haptic Feedback, to the original defaults. Haptic Feedback returns to Low. Saved History and workbook records are not deleted.

10. Find Help & Resources

Help & Resources places destinations first so users can quickly reach the guide, workbook, downloads, troubleshooting, installation guidance, and feedback. Every Quick Explanation header also includes a short helper line describing what opens beneath it.

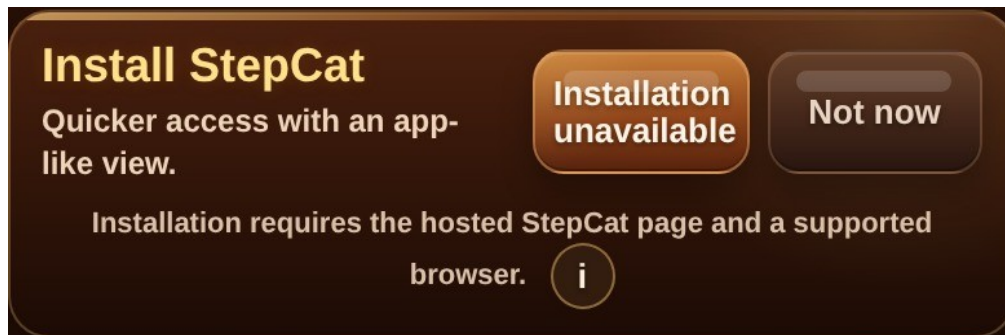
- Open Quick Start Guide
- Open Full Documentation
- Make a Google Sheets Copy
- Quick Start PDF
- Editable DOCX
- Rules & Troubleshooting
- Spreadsheet Copy Help
- Installation & Shortcuts
- Write Feedback



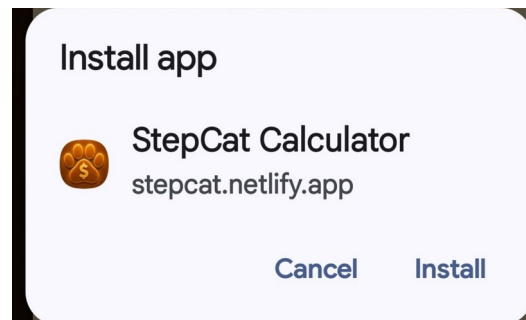
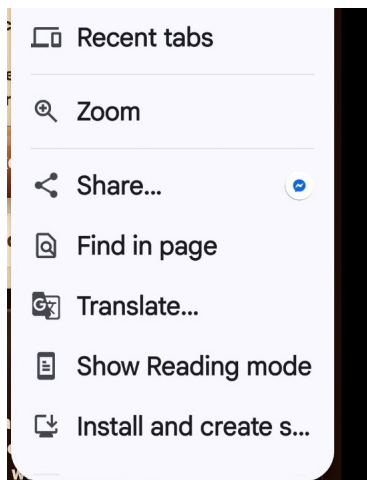
Help & Resources uses lighter Expand/Collapse controls, short helper descriptions under every Quick Explanation title, and consistent subsection headers for guides, troubleshooting, downloads, installation, and feedback.

11. Install StepCat or create a shortcut

Installation requires the hosted StepCat page and a supported browser. The main information button opens a compact dialog with X and Close controls, so users return to the same place on the main page.

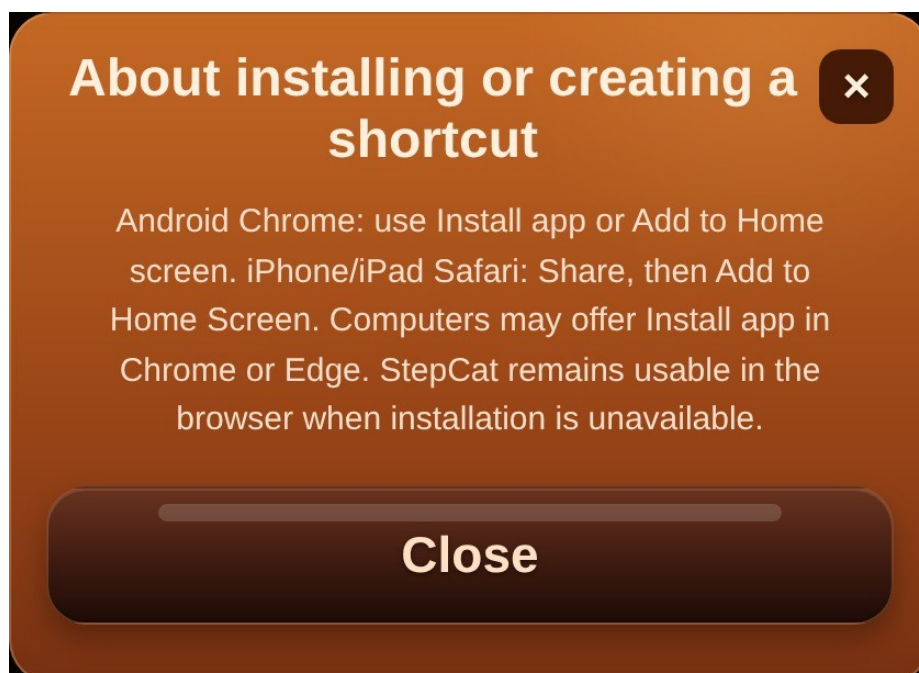


The Install StepCat card reports the current installation state. Its information button explains installation and shortcut alternatives without opening Help & Resources.



Android Chrome may offer Install app or Add to Home screen.

Confirm installation when the browser provides the prompt.



Installation and shortcut information opens in a compact dialog with X and Close controls.



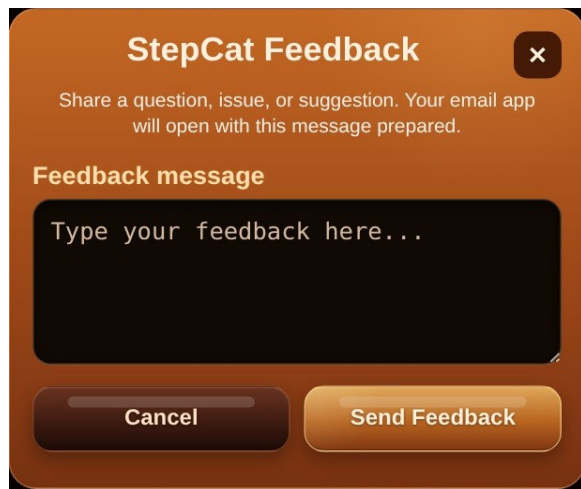
Installed StepCat icon on the device home screen.

Hosted release check

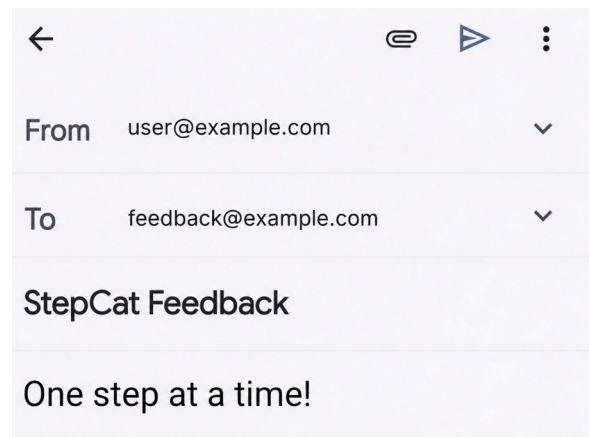
After uploading a new release, close open StepCat tabs and the installed app, then reopen the hosted site.
Confirm the visible app version is v252.1 R9 and the service worker is the R9 cache.

12. Send feedback

Write Feedback is available from the main page and Help & Resources. The main-page button centers its title and helper text. Enter a message, continue to the email app, and review the prepared recipient, subject, and message before sending.

A screenshot of the 'StepCat Feedback' dialog box. The title bar is orange with the text 'StepCat Feedback' and a close button (X). Below the title bar, there is a line of text: 'Share a question, issue, or suggestion. Your email app will open with this message prepared.' Underneath this is the section 'Feedback message' followed by a large text input field with the placeholder text 'Type your feedback here...'. At the bottom of the dialog are two buttons: 'Cancel' and 'Send Feedback'.

Enter feedback inside StepCat.

A screenshot of an email review screen. At the top is a navigation bar with a back arrow, an email icon, a send icon, and a menu icon. Below this are two rows for email addresses: 'From user@example.com' and 'To feedback@example.com', each with a dropdown arrow. The subject line is 'StepCat Feedback'. The body of the email is 'One step at a time!'.

Review the prepared email before sending.

13. Migrate old workbook data

Simple migration

In the old workbook, copy Game Records from A5 through column M on the last used row. In the new workbook, paste into A5.

1. Make a backup copy of the old workbook.
2. Open the old workbook's Game Records sheet.
3. Select A5:M[last used row]. Example: A5:M54.
4. Copy the selected range.
5. **Continue using a working v252 Google Sheets copy, or make the visually updated v252.1 copy when you want the clearer Instructions sheet; then select Game Records cell A5.**
6. Paste. Use Values only when available.
7. Confirm the first and last records appear once and that N-Z formulas calculate.
 - Do not copy rows 1-4.
 - Do not copy the column headings.
 - Do not copy columns N-Z.
 - Do not copy or replace whole sheets.
 - Existing named workbook rows do not need SC Record IDs.

14. Troubleshooting and rules

Issue	What to do
Calculate does not continue	Correct the highlighted field. StepCat scrolls to the first blocking error.
Free Game fee is rejected	Set Entry Fee to 0 or use another Payment / Record Type.
Membership or Entry Mode reset	Enable the corresponding Remember setting, or make a fresh selection.
Saved entry returned as a draft	Confirm the hosted page and service worker are v252.1. Successful saves clear completed draft storage.
Disqualified returned after reopening	v252.1 never restores Disqualified through draft recovery. Start a fresh entry and confirm the active release.
Copied row did not calculate	Paste into the column-A cell and preserve formula columns N-Z.
Installation unavailable	Use the hosted page in a supported browser, or follow Add to Home Screen guidance.
Drawer changed after Settings	v252.1 preserves live drawer state; startup defaults apply only after load or refresh.

Unsaved-entry protection

Clear Entry and Start New Entry warn before discarding meaningful unfinished content. Continue Editing is the safe default.

For the complete reference, open Full Documentation from Help & Resources. Existing v252 Google Sheets copies remain compatible. The v252.1 spreadsheet keeps the same A–M paste workflow and established formulas while reorganizing the Instructions sheet and visual formatting for clarity.